Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements Norway, Denmark, Iceland

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Applicability

Bayer Level:	CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit ☒ PH ☒ CH

GBS Location
☐ Global Business Services Barcelona
☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil
☐ Global Business Services Manila
☒ Global Business Services Gdansk
☐ Global Business Services India
☐ Global Business Services Dalian
☐ Global Business Services Germany

Region/ Country
☐ Global
☒ Specific Country: Norway, Denmark, Iceland

Relevance for R&D QMS
☐ Affected
☐ Interface
☒ N/A

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Relevant Process and Activities:	PTC

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1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Service in process steps like complaint initiation, classification forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final approval including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This SOP defines clear guidance to the Global Business Service regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This SOP is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CMO	Contract Manufacturing Organization
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Service
OTC products	Over-the-counter products
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit

3 Purpose & Set-Up

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for Norway, Denmark and Iceland are described in this SOP, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Service all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of Global Business Services follow the SOP during complaint processing in the complaint database on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

GBS team	- Enters PTCs, Suspected Counterfeit Incidents and Usability Issues according to defined timelines in a timely manner, entering them into the global complaint database in English language - Organizes missing information and asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language) - Performs the initial intake of complaints after receipt - Informs the CQU about all PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential counterfeits and any other cases described in this SOP - Informs the respective PV about all PTCs with a potential associated AE or LODE or potentially reportable medical device complaints, including the unique complaint database number and all relevant follow-up information - Forwards the case to the respective RQU for further assessment - Initiates the process of sample shipment if requested by RQU or specified in any other guidance document - Reviews the case for plausibility and closes the complaint case in complaint database - Sends out standard response letters in case it is agreed with the CQU - Forwards all cases that are not PTCs back to the CQU or to the appropriate function for further processing
Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU)	- Is responsible for regular KPI evaluation to get overview of complaint activities at the GBS - Supports the GBS in organizing missing complaint information - Organizes the complaint sample and sends it to the RQU if requested. - Sends out the Response Letters to the complainants as requested and agreed with the GBS - Contacts local CMO on request of GBS as RQU to get investigation reports from the respective CMO - Ensures that all changes within the country law and regulation are directly notified to the GBS and that the Country Specific SOP is updated

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4.1.1 General Information

In the following countries the Bayer company operates under legal entities described as below:

Norwegian office:

Bayer AS

Drammensveien 288

N-0283 Oslo

Mail: Box 193, 1325 Lysaker. Norway

Danish office:

Bayer A/S

Country Quality

Arne Jacobsens Alle 13

DK-2300 Copenhagen, Denmark

Iceland:

There is no legal entity in this country as the Danish office is responsible for Icelandic operations

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4.1.2 Contact list

Complaints for Norway, Denmark and Iceland are received at the general email address:

reklamationer@bayer.com

Generic CQU email address: *quality.nordic@bayer.com*

Iceland:

Contact person outside of Bayer:

Anna Elín Kjartansdóttir, Quality Manager/Responsible Person

E-mail address: annak@icepharma.is

Maria Sif Sigurðardóttir

E-mail address: mariasif@icepharma.is

Remark:
Current name and e-mail address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint:

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list	
4.1.3 Escalation Rules The CQH and the CQH deputy should be notified via notification/immediate action in the complaint database about any complaint case referring to at least one of the following situations: - Suspected Counterfeit Cases - Any cases involving Health Authorities - Cases with final risk category high or medium (escalation via immediate action) **Remark:** The current names and e-mail addresses of the CQH and the CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list	GBS
4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases If a complaint case is related to any type of Adverse Event, the Pharmacovigilance department has to be informed within 24 hours via the following e-mail address: PV.nordics@bayer.com	GBS
4.1.5 Product Samples **Norway:** Complaint samples can be obtained from pharmacies, wholesalers, parallel importers, healthcare providers or private consumers. The complainants are requested to send the samples for investigation directly to RQU provided the sample is requested by RQU. There is also an option of collecting the sample directly from the complainant at Bayer's cost. The consumer needs to be notified about the reimbursement rules, so it is advised to ask the consumer to leave the sample at the pharmacy. If the sample shipment is proceeded without pharmacy involvement, then the customer is not entitled to apply for reimbursement from Bayer. **Pickup of the sample:** Shipment order (Proforma faktura) should be filled in with information received from the consumer about the package's weight and approximate value, address of the pickup point, telephone number, email address and name of the person responsible for the packages release. Additionally, description of the content and PTC number must be filled in. **Shipment order:** Proforma faktura Completed Shipment order form should be sent to the Norwegian reception desk at: bayer.sentral@bayer.com together with the recipient details, so it can be registered at the vendor and the shipment label can be forwarded to the complainant for further proceeding of the sample shipment.	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
Denmark: Complaint samples that are returned by the customers via the pharmacies are delivered to the wholesalers (Nomeco or Tjellesen Max Jenne (TMJ)) and forwarded to the Danish office in Copenhagen. At the Danish office, the samples that arrive are marked with the wholesalers' reference number and forwarded to the respective RQUs. All relevant documents that came with the sample are scanned and sent by email to GBS PTC officers at the generic email address to inform that the sample will be forwarded soon. Therefore, the wholesaler's internal reference number should always be populated in the complaint database for internal coordination. Parallel importers (such as Paranova, Orifarm, 2Care4, Abacus Medicine) should be instructed to send the complaint samples marked with the parallel importers' reference number directly to respective RQUs. **Iceland**: Icelandic complainants are requested to send the sample for investigation, only when asked by the RQU. In this case GBS PTC officer can request the sample from Icepharma contact person. **Radiology Samples:** If requested by regional manager or RQU, the medical device sample is shipped to manufacturing site or lead investigation site with CQH coordination.	
4.1.6 Statement letter **Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in:** Complaints received from external sources require acknowledgement letter. Standard acknowledgement letter is filled in by GBS PTC officer according to templates in Annex 2. **Response Letter after closing:** Standard response letters are sent out when requested by the complainant (directly or if it is understood from the complaint that a response is needed). Standard response letter provided in Annex 3 is sent out without involvement of the CQU. **Exception:** # Confirmed final risk categories high and medium # In case of PTC + AE: involvement of PV # Authority responses For those exceptional cases, the GBS PTC officers need to align the response letter with CQU before submitting response to complainant. **Radiology Response letter:** Response letter is requested from the RQU by the PTC officer at *ricustomercomplaints@bayer.com* when the final risk classification is medium or high.	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

Response letter is provided by PTC officer when the final risk classification is low. Template with the response letter in Annex 7 should be filled in accordingly.

Primovist Plunger Resistance Response letter:

See details in section 4.1.14 Others.

Essex response letter to Phoenix Lab:

See details in section 4.1.14 Others.

Reimbursement of IUS/IUD request:

In case of questions regarding reimbursement of the IUS/IUD, response letter from Annex 6 should be sent in the respective language (Norwegian or Danish).

4.1.7 RQU Contact list

GBS

A table with all available products in the country, needed for entry into the complaint database, is available on SharePoint: go/ptcops.

For CH products registration status in the respective country as well as Manufacturing Site are available via SYNAPS: go/synaps.

List with the respective RQU contact names are provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint:

PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx*

CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*

4.1.8 List of Local Opportunities Products

n/a

4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements

Denmark, Norway, Iceland and Poland follow the rules of the same EU GDPR act, hence there is no restrictions in personal data flow. Every e-mail should contain data privacy statement.

4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation)

GBS
CQU

In case when the CQU receives a complaint first by a phone, then Product Complaint Form (see Annex 1) is preferably used to document received information. The CQU sends this form to GBS via e-mail.

Complaints in Norwegian and Danish are hosted in GBS office by GBS PTC officers with Norwegian language. In case of their absence, the backup officers follow the translation rules in regards with standard procedure for macro languages.

In case of Icelandic complaints that are not received in English, our Icelandic contact person (see 4.1.2) can be asked for translation of the complaint to English.

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement Complainants may only receive replacement products or refunds via the pharmacy or retailer and the decision is up to the pharmacy/retailer. A receipt of the purchase is usually necessary. The pharmacy/retailer can then be repaid/credited by the wholesaler that provided the product to the pharmacy/retailer. Complaint samples should be returned as followed: PH products (prescription medicinal products, including BT products) – the sample can be returned in any pharmacy. CH products (OTC, cosmetics, food supplements) – the sample can be returned only at the pharmacy/retailer where the product was purchased. RD products – reimbursement is upon business decision of Country Group Head Nordics or Regional Business Manager. The complaint sample should preferably be returned to the pharmacy/retailer. If the complaint sample of a medicinal product cannot be provided to the pharmacy, the healthcare professional should inform the pharmacy of the product name, batch number and complaint reason and confirm that the complaint sample has been disposed of. For questions regarding reimbursements from the wholesalers, Customer service can be contacted at: *customerservice.scandinavia@bayer.com*	GBS
4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translations For all countries where the complaints are sent out for translation to the translation tool, once a year mandatory spot checks must be performed. 5% of all complaint numbers per year should be checked by native speaker (based on random selection), e.g. CQU. Important is to check the “original income text” with “translated text” provided by translation provider. GBS is the owner of the process and starts this action. GBS leads the process, picks the cases and provides report to the CQU. The CQU checks the translation and indicates any deviation. Acceptance Criteria: • No Major translation deviations • Total number of Minor translation deviations is less than 5%. . Deviations in the translation can be described as Minor or Major. • Minor translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section of a sentence has been insufficiently translated, but the essence or meaning of the original message is still captured. • Major translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section has been incorrectly translated (for example by the introduction of a new word or exclusion of a word from the original complaint in the translated version) which results in an incorrect essence or meaning in the translation of the original message.	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

In case of a major translation deviation and exceeding 5% minor cases, the GBS will be informed promptly to open a deviation in the complaint database and to ensure appropriate CAPAs.

In addition, the translation office needs to be informed.

4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases

Complaints received via phone call:

Complaints may also come via phone to the CQU office or to external call receiving company. Such complaints should be entered in English by the phone call receiver preferably to the PTC complaint form (Annex 1) and forwarded to GBS by email.

4.1.14 Others

Name of National Competent Authorities (including abbreviations):

Names of **Norwegian Health Authority Organizations**:

1. Direktoratet for medisinske produkter (DMP)
2. Norwegian Medical Agency (NOMA)

Names of **Danish Health Authority Organizations**:

1. Lægemiddelstyrelsen (LMS)
2. Danish Medicines Agency (DKMA)

Names of **Icelandic Health Authority Organizations**:

1. Icelandic Medicines Agency (IMA)

National Medicines Verification Organizations:

1. Norway: NOMVO
2. Denmark: DMVO
3. Iceland: ICEMVO

Forwarding list:

1. **Diabetes products** complaints should be forwarded to:
   NO: *diabetes.1@ascensia.com*
   DK: *diabetesdk@ascensia.com*

2. **Animal Health** complaints products should be forwarded to:
   QA-nordic@elanco.com

3. **Crop Science** complaints should be forwarded to:
   Poul Bjerre Jensen (*poul.jensen@bayer.com*)

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4. **Androcur** complaints should be forwarded to:
   medicalinformation@advanzpharma.com

5. **Nimotop** complaints should be forwarded to:
   assurancequalite@laboratoirexo.com

6. **Nasonex** complaints should be forwarded to Organon:
   NO: *dpoc.norway@organon.com*
   Information of the details about case forwarding should be shared with the respective CQH (Teams channel).

Primovist Plunger Resistance Response letter:

Confirmed Quality defect cases regarding Plunger mobility issues of Primovist 10 mL pre-filled glass syringes should be answered with the template from Annex 5.

Essex Plus complaints handling:

Essex Plus is now owned by Phoenix Labs, but both sides can receive complaint details.

Complaint details received by Phoenix Labs: Phoenix Lab registers the complaint in their own complaint database and shares complaint details with GBS. GBS PTC Officer registers the complaint and sends the complaint ID to Phoenix Lab.

Complaint details received by GBS PTC team: GBS Officer forwards all complaint details to Phoenix Lab and sends the complaint ID after entering the complaint to the complaint database. Phoenix Lab is responsible for obtaining all missing information from the complainant and for performing sample retrieval and shipment to RQU. Phoenix Lab provides case number which PTC GBS Officer adds to the case in complaint database. Once the investigation is completed, GBS PTC Officer provides response letter to Phoenix Labs with summary of the investigation report via email.

Contact email address to Phoenix Labs: medicalinformation@phoenixlabs

For cases **out of scope** for PTC entry but forwarded to PV or MedInfo, PTC officer replies with Acknowledgement mail (Annex 4).

5 Internal References

- SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”

6 External References

- N/A

History of changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective Date *(yyyy-mm-dd)*
1.0	New document	2020-06-29
2.0	p.1 Application Sheet changed for Distribution Sheet 4.1.2 Change of responsibilities 4.1.4 Timeframe of 24 h added 4.1.5 Update of contact addresses, added: links to replacement forms and new Danish contact; removed not applicable contacts to customer support 4.1.6 Exceptions added; Annex 2 and 3 added 4.1.7 Sharepoint address updated 4.1.11 Non applicable contact for Norway removed, regional business managers' contacts and customer support contacts removed (for RD) – non applicable 4.1.12 Section added due to new template requirements 4.1.13 Annex 1 added 4.1.14 Procedures for FMD alerts provided and Annex 4 added 4.1.15 MedInfo cooperation rules added	2022-03-21
3.0	# Sweden excluded from the document. For Swedish country specifics a separate country SOP is created. # Shared Service Center (SSC) is changed to Global Business Services (GBS) 4.1.2 Update of contact and email address added 4.1.5 Procedures of sample sending described more in details. Change of email address for Norwegian shipment 4.1.6 Change in radiology response letter procedure Information about Essex response letter to Phoenix Labs added 4.1.11 Reimbursement info about specific products added 4.1.15 Information about Medinfo reference number added. New information added about Organon, Crop Science, Animal Health, Essex response letter agreement, Primovist response letter (Annex 6 added) and diabetes products' complaints 7 Annex 2 and 3 modified and new Annex 5 and 6 added # Acknowledgement letter and response letter changed.	2024-11-30
4.0	# Training role updated # "Dev@Com" replaced with „complaint database" # Roles and responsibilities updated based on SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0 # Risk class nomenclature changed to medium and high # FMD Alerts paragraph removed 4.1.2 Names of the CQHs removed 4.1.6 Radiology response letter info removed	2025-06-13

	4.1.7 Updated RQU contact list 4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements (removed part related to Dev@Com) 4.1.10 Information about the timelines removed 4.1.11 Customer Service information added 4.1.13 External call receiving company added 4.1.14 Automatic reply information to Medinfo removed # Annexes 2 and 3 update	
5.0	4.1.6 Radiology Response letter paragraph added 4.1.14 Health Authorities List for each country added Androcur and Nimotop forwarding email addresses added # Annex 2 Standard acknowledgement letters updated # Annex 7 Response letter for RD low risk added # Description to Annexes added	See coversheet

Annexes

Annex 1

Product Complaint Form

Complaint created (date)……
Complaint received (date) ……

Product information:	
Product name	
Batch / lot number	
Dosage form *(cream, tablet, capsule, etc.)*	
Package type/size	
Number of packages	
Sample available?*	Yes/No
*Sample available = please keep for further potential shipment	

Complaint information:	
Complaint description (defect description, is it suspected counterfeit case, etc.)	
Adverse event reported?	Yes/No
Does the complainant expect a response from Bayer?**	
**By requesting a response, the Complainant agrees to his/hers contact data being processed by Bayer for the purpose of providing the answer to the submitted complaint *(the exact sounding to be aligned with legal)*	

Complainants' contact information attention: in the countries with special Data Privacy regulations to be replaced by the complainant code number (to be given by CQU)	
Name and surname	
E-mail address	
Telephone	
Home address	

Sender (if other than Complainant, e.g. a pharmacy)	
Senders' Name (Legal entity)	
Address	
E-Mail address	
Telephone number	

Any additional information	

Annex 2 Standard Acknowledgement Letter:

Acknowledgement letter NO DK.docx

Annex 3 Standard Response Letter

Standard response letters.docx

Annex 4 Acknowledgement for PV/Medinfo email

Acknowledgement for PV/Medinfo email

Annex 5 Primovist Plunger Resistance Response Letter

Primovist Plunger Resistance Customer

Annex 6 Reimbursement request IUS

Reimbursement request IUD Norway.cr

Reimbursement request IUD Denmark

Annex 7 Radiology Response Letter low risk category

Radiology Response Letter low

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